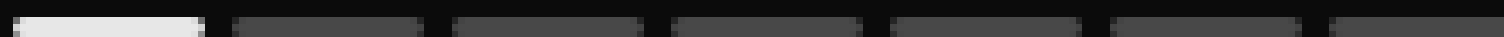


THE CHEAPER
YOU GO, THE
HARDER YOU
SELL.

Why "lower the price and the clients will come" is the most expensive
lie an underpaid expert tells themselves @samtrabulsi



"Maybe if I drop the price a bit, more people will say yes."

"Can you do it for less?"

"Sure — 50% off this week."

"I'll think about it."

"... let me know."

THE TRAP

A low price doesn't lower friction. It lowers trust.

You expect the discount to be a bridge. It becomes a flag. The buyer reads the new number as a confession — that the first one was inflated, that the work is replaceable, that you're more afraid of losing the sale than they are of making the wrong call. Cheap prices don't attract serious clients. They attract careful ones. The careful client asks for three calls before signing, two more discounts after, and a refund the moment things get hard. You're not too expensive. You're priced like someone who's negotiable, and now everything about your work is up for negotiation too.



CHEAP

"Negotiable.
Replaceable.
Always defending."



PREMIUM

"Decided.
Specific.
Worth waiting for."

THE REFRAME

You don't have a price problem. You have a positioning problem.

The number isn't what's making the buyer hesitate. The shape of the offer is. When the offer is fuzzy, every dollar feels like a risk. When the offer is specific — a named outcome, a defined scope, a person who clearly owns the result — the number becomes the smallest part of the conversation. Discounting tries to lower the cost of saying yes. Positioning tries to lower the cost of being wrong. Buyers will overpay for the second one every time. They are not shopping for cheap. They are shopping for certainty, and certainty has never been on sale.



Every call ends with "can you do it for less?"

When price is the closing topic, value never made it into the room. You spent the hour describing what you do. You should have spent it naming what they get. The buyer who only sees deliverables will always count them and subtract. The buyer who sees the outcome stops counting and pays. Your proposal needs to make the second buyer the only buyer.



You quote, then immediately defend the number.

The defense is the leak. The second you start explaining why you're worth it, the buyer hears insecurity, not value. People don't justify the price of things they're certain about. They name it and pause. If you can't sit in silence for ten seconds after quoting, the price isn't the problem — your conviction is.



Ghosters come back the moment you mention a discount.

They didn't want the work. They wanted the discount. You trained them to wait you out. The next quote will be argued from the moment it lands, because they now know the floor isn't the floor. Discount once and you negotiate forever. The buyer who pays full price the first time pays full price the second time — because nothing about the number signaled that less was ever possible.



You're always busy and never paid enough.

A full calendar with a thin bank account is not a workload problem. It is a pricing problem. You are working at volume to

THE COMPARISON

Underpriced expert vs. Premium-positioned operator

SIGNAL	UNDERPRICED	PREMIUM
Sells	Hours & tasks	Named outcomes
First objection	"Too expensive."	"When can we start?"
Client type	Bargain hunters	Decision makers
Energy after work	Drained	Reinvested
Calendar	Full and broke	Lean and paid

Stop lowering the price. Start sharpening the offer.

1

Raise your number by 30%.

Not 5%. Not 10%. A real jump that forces you to rewrite the offer around it. If the new price terrifies you, that's the right number — it pushes you past selling hours and into selling outcomes. Comfortable price increases don't change buyer behavior. Uncomfortable ones change yours, and your buyers feel that shift immediately.

2

Name the outcome it buys.

Replace the deliverable list with a single sentence describing what's different in the buyer's business or life after you finish. Specific. Measurable. Worth the price. If you can't write that sentence in plain language, the price isn't the problem — your offer is. A vague offer is the most expensive thing you can sell, because it costs you the buyer.

3

Quote the number and shut up.

Say the number. Do not defend it. Do not list features. Do not soften it with "but I'm flexible on payment." The buyer needs space to decide. The discomfort of silence is doing more selling than any extra sentence you'd add. Premium operators say the price and let it land. Underpriced ones say the price and apologize all the way to the discount.

PRO TIP

Cheap doesn't convert. Cheap consoles. Buyers don't pay for hours. They pay for certainty.



@SAMTRABULSI

Stop selling cheap. Start selling certain.

Raise the number. Sharpen the outcome. Quote it without apologizing. That's how an underpriced expert turns into a premium operator buyers chase.

Comment "BRAND"

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